

Change Management

The structured approach to moving individuals and organisations to a future state

GLOSSARY 04 - SHEET 4 / 8

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Change management is the structured approach by which individuals, teams and organisations are moved from a current state to a defined future state so that an intended benefit is realised. Where change leadership addresses direction and motivation, change management addresses the planning, sequencing, resourcing, communication and reinforcement of the transition, and it operates on the individual as the unit of change (Hiatt, 2006; Kotter, 1996).

WHO DEFINED IT ORIGINALLY

The individual-level model most used in practice is ADKAR, developed by Jeffrey M. Hiatt at Prosci from research across more than 700 organisations and published in 2006. The organisational-level antecedents are Lewin (1947) and Kotter (1996); Bridges (1991) supplies the psychological transition account.

WHY THIS DEFINITION WAS DEVELOPED

Organisational change models specified what the enterprise must do but not what must be true of each individual for the change to occur. Hiatt's contribution was to make the individual the unit of analysis and to sequence the five conditions, so that a stalled change could be diagnosed by identifying which condition was absent rather than by repeating the whole programme.

FIGURE 1 - FIVE SEQUENTIAL CONDITIONS

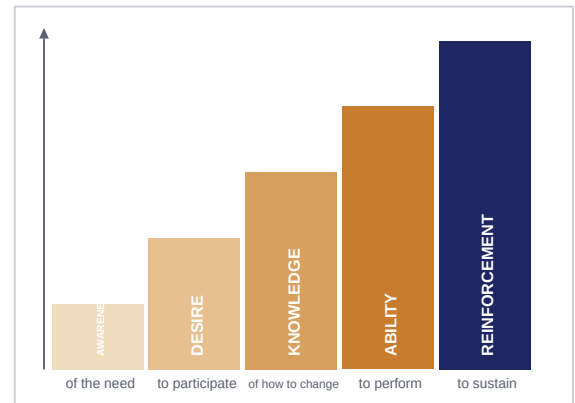


Figure 1. The conditions are sequential, not parallel. Training delivers knowledge and ability; where desire is the missing condition, additional training produces competent non-adopters and no behavioural change (after Hiatt, 2006).

HOW IT IS USED

Diagnose which of the five sequential conditions - awareness, desire, knowledge, ability, reinforcement - is missing for the affected population, and address that one; effort spent on later conditions while an earlier one is absent produces no movement.

WHEN IT IS USED

From the design phase of an AI initiative rather than before go-live, when usage stalls after training, when a change reverts after attention moves elsewhere, and at every significant process redesign.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Change managers and human resources partners, line managers who deliver reinforcement, project sponsors funding the change effort, and adoption leads diagnosing stalled deployments.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Lewin's three-step model described the organisation's state transitions and offered no diagnostic granularity; a stalled change could only be re-run. ADKAR decomposes the transition into five conditions that are individually observable and strictly sequential, which converts change management from a communications programme into a diagnosis. Its practical value in AI adoption is that it distinguishes cannot from will not - knowledge and ability gaps from desire gaps - which require different remedies.

RELATED DEFINITIONS IN THIS COURSE

Change Leadership - Unit 2

AI Adoption - Unit 4

Technology Acceptance Model - Unit 4

Reskilling and Upskilling - Unit 4

Organisational Culture - Unit 2

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Bridges, W. (1991) Managing Transitions: Making the Most of Change. Reading, MA: Addison-Wesley.
 Hiatt, J.M. (2006) ADKAR: A Model for Change in Business, Government and Our Community. Loveland, CO: Prosci Learning Center Publications.
 Kotter, J.P. (1996) Leading Change. Boston, MA: Harvard Business School Press.
 Lewin, K. (1947) 'Frontiers in group dynamics', Human Relations, 1(1), pp. 5-41.